

Word family: **plan / plans / planned / planning / planner**

Base word: plan

Past tense: planned

Past participle: planned

ing form: planning

Related forms: planner, planning

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “We did not need expensive toys or fancy **plans**, because we could turn almost anything into fun.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **plan** means an **arrangement or idea about what you are going to do**, especially something organized in advance.

The speaker means that he and Ryan did not need carefully organized activities or special arrangements to enjoy themselves.

繁體中文： **預先想好或安排好的活動、行動方式或打算；計劃**

中文翻譯：

> “We did not need expensive toys or fancy **plans**...”

「我們不需要昂貴的玩具，也不需要甚麼花巧的**計劃 / 安排**.....」

Here:

fancy plans = 精心安排、較講究的活動計劃

1. **plan = intended course of action (行動安排) — 計劃；打算；方案**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: An idea or arrangement about what you intend to do and how you intend to do it.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We did not need fancy **plans** to have fun.”

「我們不需要甚麼花巧的**計劃**也可以玩得開心。」

Practice 2

> “What are your **plans** for the weekend?”

「你週末有甚麼**計劃 / 安排**？」

Practice 3

> “The original **plan** was to leave early.”

「原本的**計劃**是早點離開。」

****plan = 對未來準備做甚麼、如何做所作出的預先安排或打算****

Common:

- * make a plan
- * change a plan
- * follow a plan
- * future plans
- * travel plans
- * plans for the weekend

These belong to one broad ****intended course of action**** sense.

2. ****plan = detailed method/proposal for achieving something (方案) — 方案；規劃****

A ****plan**** can be more formal and detailed: a structured proposal showing how a goal will be achieved.

Practice 4

> “The company introduced a new five-year ****plan****.”

「公司推出了一項新的五年****計劃 / 規劃方案****。」

Practice 5

> “We need a clear ****plan**** for reducing costs.”

「我們需要一個清晰的****方案****來降低成本。」

****plan = 為達成某個目標而制定的較有系統、具步驟或策略的安排****

This is closely related to Meaning 1.

For strict database counting, I would normally ****merge it with #1****, because both involve:

> ****a proposed course of future action****

The difference is mainly degree of detail and formality, not a fundamentally different concept.

3. ****plan = drawing/map showing layout or structure (圖則) — 平面圖；設計圖；圖則****

This is a genuinely different noun meaning.

****Meaning:**** A drawing that shows the arrangement, dimensions, or structure of a building, room, site, machine, etc.

Practice 6

> “The architect showed us the floor ****plan****.”

「建築師給我們看了****平面圖****。」

Practice 7

> “The builders checked the ****plans**** before starting work.”

「建築工人在開工前查看了****圖則 / 設計圖****。」

****plan = 顯示建築物、房間、土地或其他結構如何排列、設計或建造的圖****

Common:

- * floor plan
- * building plan
- * site plan
- * architectural plans

This is clearly different from:

> “What are your plans for tonight?”

4. **plan = intend / decide in advance (動詞) — 計劃 ; 打算**

As a verb, **plan** means to decide in advance what you are going to do.

Practice 8

> “We **plan** to visit the museum tomorrow.”

「我們**打算 / 計劃**明天參觀博物館。」

Practice 9

> “She **planned** everything carefully.”

「她把所有事情都仔細**計劃好了**。」

****plan to do something = 預先決定自己準備做某件事****

****plan something = 預先安排某件事情如何進行****

This is the main verb meaning.

5. **plan = organize/design something in advance (安排 / 策劃) — 規劃 ; 策劃**

The verb can also emphasize preparing the details of an event, activity, system, or project.

Practice 10

> “They are **planning** a surprise party.”

「他們正在**策劃 / 安排**一個驚喜派對。」

Practice 11

> “The route was carefully **planned**.”

「路線經過仔細**規劃**。」

****plan something = 預先設計、安排或組織某件事情的細節****

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 4.

The underlying concept is still:

> **decide/organize in advance**

6. **plan for something (預作準備) — 為.....作準備 / 規劃**

This construction emphasizes preparing for a future situation, especially one that may require resources or action.

Practice 12

> “Families need to **plan for** unexpected expenses.”

「家庭需要為突如其來的開支**預作規劃 / 準備**。」

Practice 13

> “The city is **planning for** future population growth.”

「這座城市正在為未來人口增長**作規劃**。」

plan for something = 預先考慮某種未來情況，並為它安排所需行動或資源

This belongs to the main verb sense rather than being a new core meaning.

Related form: **planning**

Planning means the process of deciding and organizing something in advance.

Practice 14

> “Good **planning** can prevent many problems.”

「良好的**規劃 / 計劃**可以避免很多問題。」

Practice 15

> “The event required months of **planning**.”

「這項活動需要幾個月的**籌備 / 策劃**。」

planning = 預先決定目標、步驟、安排或資源的過程

Related form: **planner**

A **planner** can mean a person who makes plans professionally or an object/book/app used for organizing schedules.

planner = person who plans (規劃人員)

Practice 16

> “She works as an urban **planner**.”

「她是一名城市**規劃師**。」

Practice 17

> “The event **planner** arranged everything.”

「活動**策劃人**安排了所有事情。」

planner = 負責制定、設計或安排計劃的人

planner = diary/tool for organizing schedules (記事 / 行程工具) — 行事曆 ; 計劃簿

Practice 18

> “I write all my appointments in my **planner**.”

「我把所有約會都寫在我的**行事曆 / 計劃簿**裡。」

Practice 19

> “The app works as a weekly **planner**.”

「這個應用程式可以當作每週**行程規劃工具**。」

planner = 用來安排日期、任務和行程的記事工具

Important distinction: **plan** vs **idea**

idea

is any thought, suggestion, or concept.

plan

goes further: it concerns what you actually intend to do and often how you will do it.

> “I have an idea.”

= 我有一個想法。

> “I have a plan.”

= 我已經有一個行動計劃 / 打算。

An idea may become a plan after details are worked out.

Important distinction: **plan vs intention**

intention

focuses on what someone means or intends to do.

plan

usually includes more concrete arrangements or proposed actions.

> “I intend to study abroad.”

= 我有這個意向。

> “My plan is to study abroad next year.”

= 已有較具體的時間 / 安排。

So:

intention = 意圖 / 意向

plan = 計劃 / 安排

Important distinction: **plan vs schedule**

plan

describes what you intend to do.

schedule

focuses on **when** activities happen and often their exact timing.

> “Our plan is to visit three cities.”

> “Our schedule says we leave at 8:00.”

So:

plan = 做甚麼、怎樣做

schedule = 何時做

Important distinction: **plan vs strategy**

plan

is a broad arrangement for future action.

strategy

usually refers to an overall approach designed to achieve a difficult or competitive goal.

> business plan

> marketing strategy

A strategy may form part of a larger plan.

Important distinction: **plan vs proposal**

plan

may already be intended for implementation.

proposal

is something formally suggested for consideration or approval.

> “They submitted a proposal.”

does not necessarily mean it has been accepted as the final plan.

Important distinction: **plan** vs **map**

This matters for the drawing sense.

plan

shows the layout or structure of something, often from above and often for design/construction.

map

shows geographical locations, roads, regions, etc.

> floor plan = 平面圖

> city map = 城市地圖

Useful expression: **go according to plan** — 按計劃進行

Practice 20

> “Everything went according to **plan**.”

「所有事情都**按計劃進行**。」

Practice 21

> “If everything goes according to **plan**, we’ll finish tomorrow.”

「如果一切都**按計劃進行**，我們明天就能完成。」

according to plan = 按照原先安排好的方式進行

Useful expression: **have other plans** — 另有安排

Practice 22

> “I’d love to come, but I already have other **plans**.”

「我很想來，但我已經**另有安排**。」

Practice 23

> “She had other **plans** for the evening.”

「她晚上**另有安排**。」

This belongs to the ordinary **future arrangement** sense.

Useful expression: **plan ahead** — 提前計劃

Practice 24

> “It helps to **plan ahead** before a long trip.”

「長途旅行前**提早計劃**會很有幫助。」

Practice 25

> “We should **plan ahead** for winter.”

「我們應該為冬天**預先作好計劃**。」

plan ahead = 比需要行動的時間更早開始考慮和安排

This is a fixed construction, not another core meaning.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **plan**

* **plans**

* **planned**

* **planning**

* **planner**

Useful compounds and constructions include:

- * action plan
- * business plan
- * floor plan
- * site plan
- * travel plans
- * plan to do something
- * plan for something
- * plan ahead
- * according to plan

The Golden Manual says grammatical constructions, useful family forms, and established compounds should be checked, while closely related contexts should be merged whenever the same underlying semantic idea still works.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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plan — intended course of action	對未來準備做甚麼、如何做所作出的預先安排、打算或方案
plan — formal/detailed proposal	為達成某個目標而制定的有系統行動方案；與一般 future-action 義高度相關
plan — drawing/layout	顯示建築物、房間、土地或其他結構如何排列、設計或建造的圖則 / 平面圖
plan — verb	預先決定、安排或組織自己準備做甚麼，以及如何進行
plan for something	預先考慮未來情況並為它安排所需行動或資源
planning	預先制定目標、步驟、安排和資源的過程
planner — person	負責制定、設計或安排計劃的人
planner — organizing tool	用來安排日期、任務和行程的記事 / 規劃工具

For your original sentence

> “We did not need expensive toys or fancy ****plans****...”

The exact meaning is:

****plan = 預先想好或安排好的活動 / 行動方式****

More specifically:

****fancy plans = 很講究、精心安排或較複雜的活動計劃****

So the speaker is saying:

> ****我們不需要昂貴的玩具，也不需要特別精心安排活動，也可以玩得很開心。****

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely distinct core meanings** for **plan**:

1. **noun — an intended future course of action / arrangement**
2. **noun — a drawing showing the layout or structure of something**
3. **verb — decide, organize, or arrange something in advance**

I would merge **formal plan / action plan / future plans** under #1, merge **plan to / plan for / plan ahead** under #3, and keep **planning** and **planner** as family extensions rather than inflate the core count.